Idaho Technology Authority (ITA)

ENTERPRISE GUIDELINES – G500 SECURITY PROCEDURES

Category: G540 – MOBILE DEVICES

CONTENTS:

I. Definition
II. Rationale
III. Guideline
IV. Procedure Reference
V. Contact Information
Revision History
Appendix: A

I. DEFINITIONS

See ITA Enterprise Guideline G105 (Glossary of Terms) for any definitions.

II. RATIONALE

With the increasing use of mobile devices in the workplace, organizations must address security risks while maximizing productivity. Personal Digital Assistants (PDAs), tablets, and other handheld devices have become essential tools for the mobile workforce, enabling seamless communication and data access. However, these devices also introduce security challenges due to their ability to store and transmit information across wired and wireless networks.
This guideline provides a framework for managing mobile devices, helping organizations establish policies to ensure secure and efficient use.

III. GUIDELINE

A. Security Overview

Basic mobile device security policies:

1. Mobile devices connected to agency equipment should be password protected;
2. The wireless port on mobile devices should be disabled when not in use;
3. All mobile devices should have installed anti-virus software;
4. Mobile devices that do not have up-to-date anti-virus software should be scanned for viruses prior to connecting to the agency network;
5. Storing sensitive agency information is not recommended unless it is encrypted; and
6. Mobile devices should have the latest security patches installed on their operating system.

State of Idaho - Unrestricted/Public

7. Mobile devices are inherently less secure devices; additional measures should be put in place to properly protect sensitive information. See Section G for more details.

B. Physical Security

Users must maintain the physical security of their mobile devices:

1. Storage: Keep devices out of sight and covered when stored in a vehicle.
2. Public Areas: Exercise caution in crowds, meetings, and security screening areas to prevent loss or theft.
3. Identification: Attach a tag or label with contact information to facilitate recovery if lost.
4. Reporting: Immediately notify the appropriate security or network administrator if a device is lost, stolen, or compromised.

C. Device Security

To safeguard State systems and data, follow these security practices for mobile devices:

1. Software Security: Script files must not store user IDs or passwords for State systems.
2. Authentication: Enable power-on authentication on all devices.
3. Unattended Devices: Use a screen saver with password protection or a keyboard lock.
4. Password Guidelines: Refer to Information Technology Enterprise Standard S6030 – Identity and Authentication.
5. Travel Precautions: Transport mobile devices as carry-on luggage unless regulations require otherwise.
6. Updates & Patches:
    a) Keep devices updated with the latest security patches and virus protection.
    b) Automate updates when possible, and apply critical patches within 48 hours of release.
7. Firewall Protection: Install and update firewall software on devices connecting to the State network from outside the State firewall.
8. Data Security:
    a) Enable remote wipe capability to protect State data on lost or stolen devices.
    b) Use a Mobile Device Management solution for automated security enforcement.

D. Data Security

To safeguard State data

State of Idaho - Unrestricted/Public

1. Encryption: Encrypt sensitive or confidential data stored on mobile devices. For added security, encrypt data, store it on removable media, and keep the media separate from the device or case.
2. Device Disposal: Include mobile devices in the surplus equipment and disposal lifecycle to ensure complete data removal before returning them to vendors or surplus. Refer to ITA Guideline G550 – Cleansing Data from Surplus Computer Equipment for proper disposal procedures.

E. Communication and User Education

A successful mobile device policy requires ongoing communication and user education to ensure security and efficiency. Regular updates on policy changes, IT support, and provisioning should be shared with users through training sessions that encourage discussion and knowledge sharing.

User Education Essentials

Effective security training reduces risks and helps users protect both agency and personal data. At a minimum, user education programs and policies should:

1. Encourage Accountability: Users should understand the importance of following security policies and taking common-sense precautions.
2. Highlight Risks & Consequences: Explain the potential impact of device loss, including risks to agency reputation and exposure of sensitive personal data.
3. Provide Easy-to-Use Security Tools: Ensure authentication mechanisms, encryption, and security controls are accessible and simple to implement.
4. Demonstrate Real-World Threats: Use training sessions to show how mobile devices are vulnerable to theft and loss and outline preventive measures.

Workshops and short online training sessions focusing on security threats and best practices can help users better safeguard their devices and data.

F. Agency Policies

Agencies should develop mobile device policies that align with their specific security and operational needs. Consider incorporating the following elements:

1. Application Restrictions: Define which apps users are permitted to download and install.
2. Data Access & Restrictions: Establish guidelines for authorized and restricted data, including sensitive information.
3. Connectivity Controls: Specify approved connectivity methods, such as Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, or external communication ports.

A more restrictive policy tailored to agency requirements can enhance security while maintaining efficiency.

G. Tiered Mobile Device Management Model

State of Idaho - Unrestricted/Public

Some agencies may require a more dynamic mobile device management approach focused on data rather than device type. Agencies that meet the following requirements may implement a **tiered security model**, which will be considered compliant with ITA policy and standards:

1. Data Classification: The agency must classify all data per ITA Enterprise Policy P4130 (Information Systems Classification) and ITA Enterprise Guideline G505 (Data Classification and Labeling Guideline).
2. Technical Controls: Effective measures must be in place to manage and enforce classified data flow across networks and endpoints (e.g., data loss prevention (DLP), encryption, mobile device management (MDM), etc.).
3. Stricter Security Requirements: The tiered model must enforce security controls that exceed those outlined in the standard policy.
4. Data-Centric Approach: Security classification of devices must be based on the highest classification of data the user regularly interacts with.
5. Resource Considerations: Agencies must assess the staffing and resource requirements necessary to manage a tiered model compared to a “flat” model.

Requirements by Classification:

Agencies must implement security controls based on the classification of mobile device usage.

Classification 1: Public

Devices in the category:

1. Are personally owned and never used for state business.
2. Only interact with openly available websites, documents, and information.
3. May connect only to unauthenticated, public state-operated networks.
4. No mobile device management (MDM) client is required, and no policies are enforced.

Classification 2: Limited

Devices in this category interact with limited-classified data, such as internal email, which may or may not be exempt from public record requests. These devices may be personally-owned or state-owned and must have a Mobile Device Management (MDM) client to monitor and enforce security policies.

Required Security Controls:

1. Device password required
2. Screen lock and inactivity timeout (10 minutes limit)
3. Device wipe and reset after 10 consecutive incorrect password attempts
4. Anti-virus software
5. Web content filtering
6. Encryption of data at-rest (including SD card if present)

State of Idaho - Unrestricted/Public

7. Encryption of data in-transit (where possible)

Classification 3: Restricted

Devices in this category **must be state-owned** and interact with **restricted-classified data**, such as:

1. Technical network or security information
2. Administrator passwords
3. Personally identifiable information (PII)

This type of information is **exempt from public records requests**, requiring stricter security measures. In addition to **Classification 2 controls**, the following must be implemented:

1. Application Whitelisting: Only approved applications may be installed.
2. Data Loss Prevention (DLP): Enforce policies to prevent unauthorized data exposure.
3. External Media Restrictions: Limit SD card use to essential operational functions.
4. Removable Storage Restrictions: Prohibit devices from functioning as removable storage.
5. Backup & Synchronization Controls: Restrict usage of sync applications (e.g., Dropbox, iCloud, OneDrive).
6. Wireless Hotspot & Tethering Restrictions: Enabled only on a per-device basis with supervisor approval and a documented business case.

These controls ensure **enhanced security** for sensitive data while maintaining compliance with agency policies.

Classification 4: Critical

Devices in this category **must be state-owned** and interact with **critical-classified data**, where disclosure could result in **significant penalties, serious injury, disability, or loss of life**. This information is **exempt from public record requests** and requires the highest security standards.

Additional Security Requirements (Beyond Lower Classifications):

1. Persistent VPN Connections: Required on all cellular and non-State networks.
2. Restricted Wireless Access: Allow only necessary network connections.
3. Personal Area Network (PAN) Restrictions: Limit Bluetooth and NFC to essential operations and only for the required duration.
4. Hardware Access Restrictions: Limit camera, microphone, and other hardware use to operational needs.
5. Controlled Wireless Hotspot & Tethering: Enabled only on a per-device basis with supervisor approval, and usage must be purpose-driven and time-limited.

State of Idaho - Unrestricted/Public

Requirements for Classifications 2-4 (Limited through Critical):

1. Secure Device Wiping & Resetting: Required before reissuance.
2. Pre-Issuance Security Measures: Devices must be secured before deployment.
3. Mobile Device Management (MDM) Client Required: Enforce policy compliance.
4. Boot-Level Password Protection: Devices must require passwords before fully booting (swipe, pattern, and PIN are insufficient).
5. Screen Lock & Inactivity Timeout: Must align with P4550 Mobile Device Management Policy.
6. Prohibited Sideloading: Installing unauthorized applications must be disabled.
7. Mandatory Security Protections: Anti-virus software, web content filtering, and encryption (at-rest & in-transit) are required.

Reference Appendix A for a graphical representation of these classifications and required controls.

IV. PROCEDURE REFERENCE

- ITA Enterprise Policy P4550 (Mobile Device Management)
- ITA Enterprise Standard S2140 (Mobile Device Capabilities)
- ITA Enterprise Standard S6030 (Identity and Authentication)
- ITA Enterprise Policy P1060 (State-Issued IT Devices)
- ITA Enterprise Guideline G550 (Cleansing Data from Surplus Computer Equipment)
- ITA Enterprise Policy P4130 (Information Systems Classification)
- ITA Enterprise Guideline G505 (Data Classification and Labeling)

V. CONTACT INFORMATION

For more information, contact the ITA Staff at (208) 605-4064.

REVISION HISTORY

09/04/2025 – The revised policy emphasizes a balanced approach between security and productivity, with clearer, more accessible language and structure. It shifts focus toward proactive policy formation, integrating and categorizing security controls into structured sections. Key technical reinforcements include stricter enforcement of authentication, remote wipe, and encryption, along with the introduction of physical security measures to mitigate theft and loss. Device management policies have been refined to align with mobile device management (MDM) best practices, and terminology has been standardized across security classifications. The policy also improves readability through better

State of Idaho - Unrestricted/Public

formatting, bullet points, and logical grouping of related elements. Additionally, user education has been streamlined to make expectations more actionable, and the policy now better aligns with existing compliance frameworks through consistent and simplified wording.

07/23/2025 – Revised for ADA compliance

04/18/2017 – Restructured document, added Tiered Mobile Device Model and Agency Policy section.

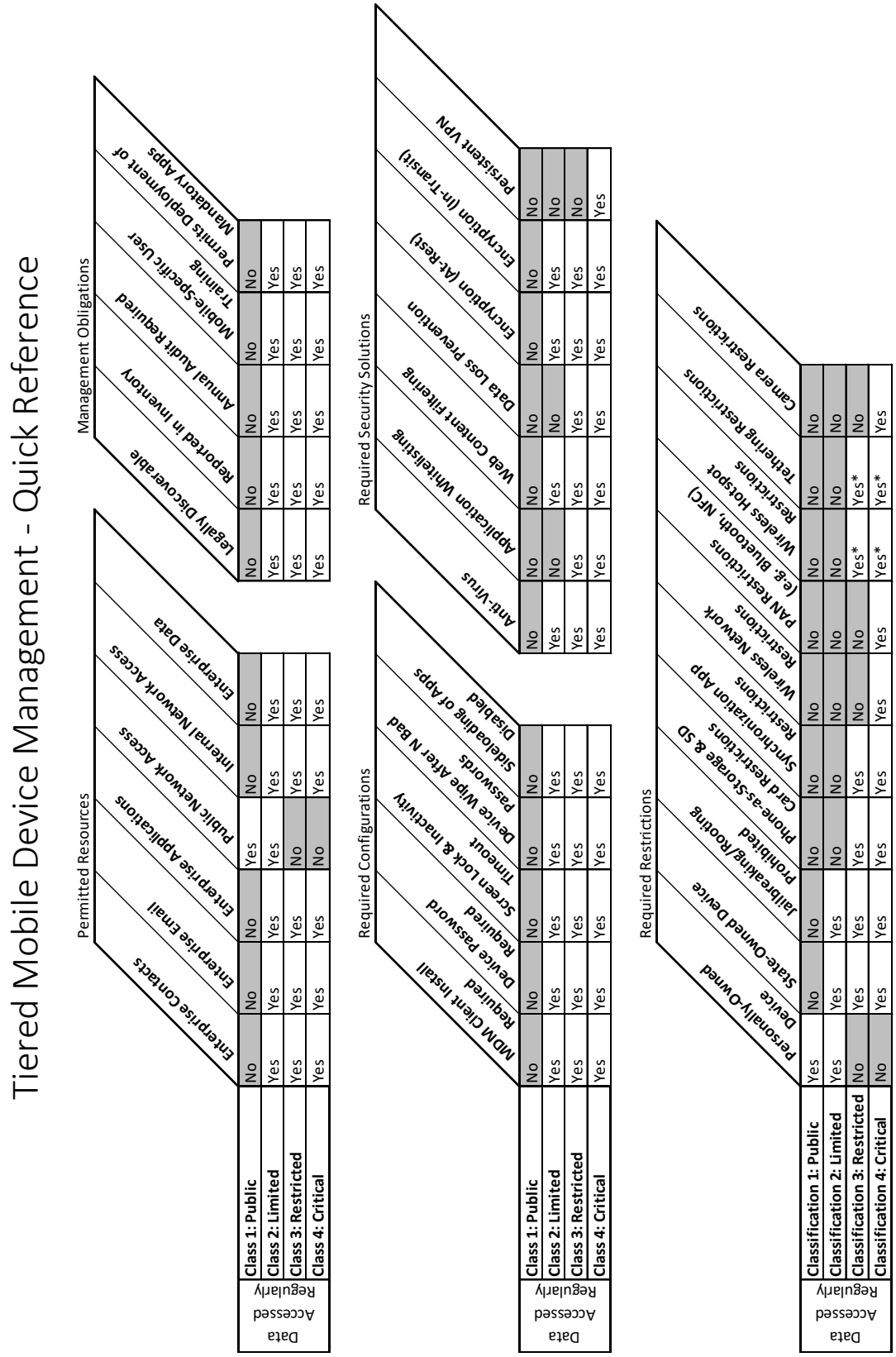
07/01/2013 – Changed “ITRMC” to “ITA”.

06/16/2009 – Added Procedure Reference, Contact Information, and Revision History to this guideline; changed the layout and deleted Timeline.

Effective Date: October 24, 2005

State of Idaho - Unrestricted/Public

APPENDIX: A



*Note: Chart is continual, but was condensed to fit on a single page

State of Idaho - Unrestricted/Public